

Bit Shift Operations

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Left Shift (<<) Operation

- Shifts all bits in a number to the left by a specified number of positions
- Fills the rightmost positions with zeros
- Effectively multiplies by 2^n where n is the shift amount

Original:

0	0	0	0	0	1	0	1
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 (5)

↓ Shift left by 2

Result:

0	0	0	1	0	1	0	0
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 (20)

1

 Original bits

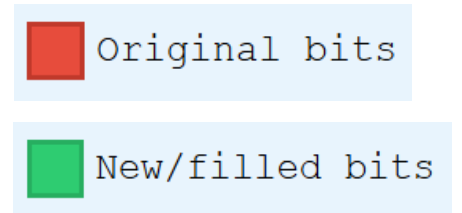
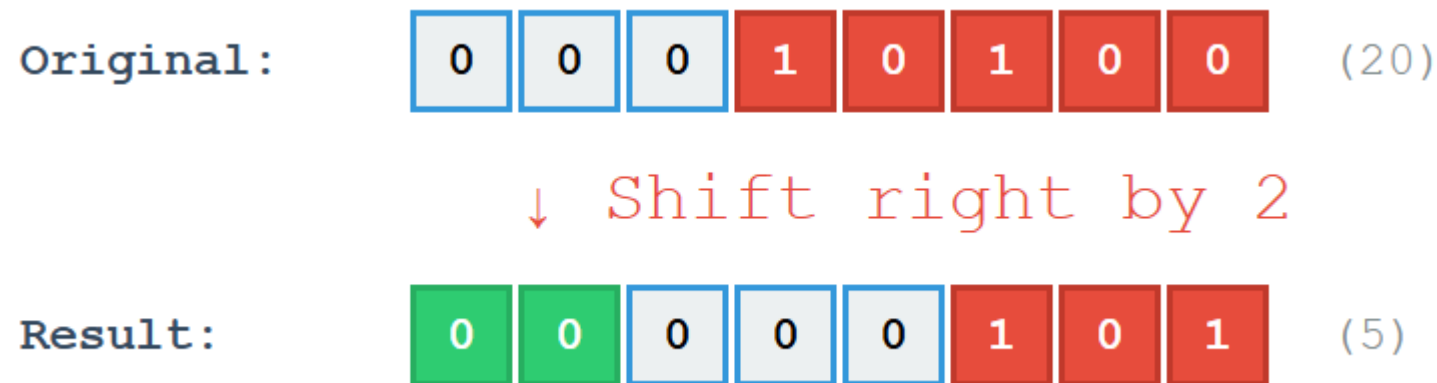
1

 New/filled bits

Example: $5 \ll 2$ (shift left by 2 positions)

Right Shift (>>) Operation

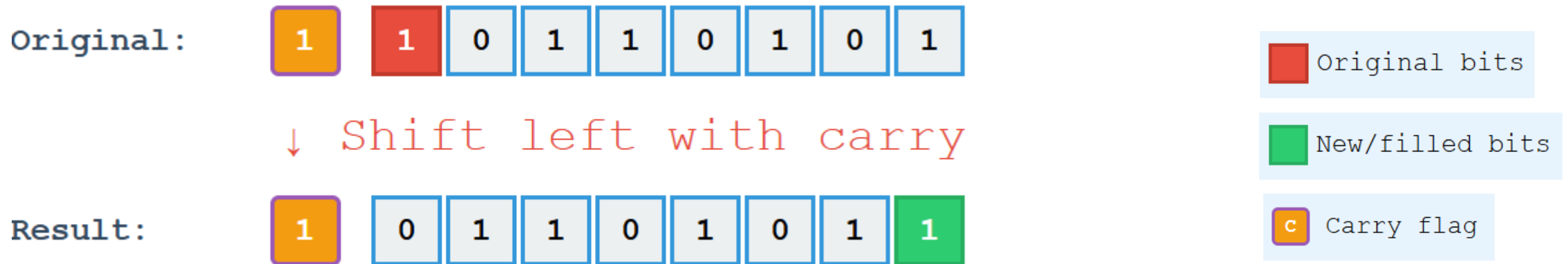
- Shifts all bits in a number to the right by a specified number of positions
- Fills the leftmost positions with zeros
- Effectively divides by 2^n where n is the shift amount



Example: `20 >> 2` (shift right by 2 positions)

Left Shift (<<) with Carry

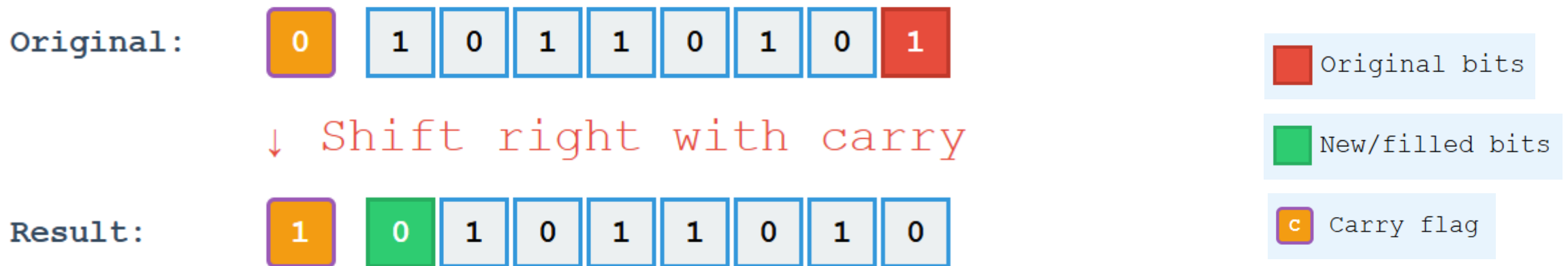
- Shifts all bits left by one position
- The leftmost bit (MSB) goes into the carry flag
- The previous carry flag value goes into the rightmost bit (LSB)
- Direction: MSB → Carry → LSB
- Useful for multi-precision arithmetic (working with numbers larger than register size), implementing rotate operations, serial data processing, checksum calculations



Example: Rotating 10110101 left through carry (carry initially = 1). MSB (1) goes to carry flag, old carry (1) fills LSB position.

Right Shift (>>) with Carry

- Shifts all bits right by one position
- The rightmost bit (LSB) goes into the carry flag
- The previous carry flag value goes into the leftmost bit (MSB)
- Direction: LSB → Carry → MSB
- Useful for multi-precision arithmetic (working with numbers larger than register size), implementing rotate operations, serial data processing, checksum calculations



Example: Rotating 10110101 right through carry (carry initially = 0). LSB (1) goes to carry flag, old carry (0) fills MSB position.